

★ TIA Quick Reference Card

Teacher Incentive Allotment — Everything You Need to Know at a Glance

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TIA Designation Levels & Pay

	Recognized	Exemplary	Master
Annual Stipend	\$3,000 – \$9,000	\$6,000 – \$18,000	\$12,000 – \$32,000
Rural/Title I Bonus	Up to \$6,000 extra	Up to \$12,000 extra	Up to \$20,000 extra
Typical Total	\$3K – \$15K/yr	\$6K – \$30K/yr	\$12K – \$52K/yr
Difficulty	Achievable for strong teachers	Highly effective teachers	Top-tier performance
Validity	5 years (renewable)	5 years (renewable)	5 years (renewable)

💡 **Key Insight:** Teachers at high-needs campuses earn significantly more. Rural and Title I schools unlock the highest allotments.

The Two Pillars of TIA

TIA designations are based on **two weighted components**:

Pillar 1: Student Growth (min. 35% weight)

- Based on **student performance data** (STAAR, district assessments, or comparable measures)
- Must demonstrate that your students are growing — not just proficient
- Districts choose which assessments count

Pillar 2: Teacher Observation (min. 35% weight)

- Scored on the **T-TESS rubric** (or approved alternative)
- Requires calibrated, trained appraisers

- Multiple observations per year for reliability
- Focus areas: Planning, Instruction, Learning Environment, Professionalism



Weighting: Each pillar must be at least 35%. Your district sets the exact split (commonly 50/50 or 45/55). The remaining weight can go to either pillar.



Key Dates in the TIA Cycle

When	What Happens
Aug – Sep	District submits/updates TIA system application to TEA
Sep – May	Observation windows & student assessment data collection
Jan – Mar	Mid-year check-in — review your observation scores
May – Jun	Final observation scores & student growth data compiled
Jun – Aug	District submits teacher data to TEA for designation
Sep – Nov	TEA reviews and issues designation decisions
Dec – Jan	Designated teachers begin receiving allotment payments



Don't wait until spring! Start collecting evidence and requesting observations early in the school year.



Is Your District TIA-Approved?

Not all Texas districts participate in TIA yet. Check your district's status:



TEA TIA District Lookup:

<https://tea.texas.gov/texas-educators/educator-initiatives-and-performance/teacher-incentive-allotment>

If your district isn't participating yet:

- Talk to your principal or HR about TIA interest
- Districts can apply during the annual application window

- TEA provides free technical assistance to districts exploring TIA

5 Quick-Start Action Items

Starting your TIA journey? Do these five things NOW:

1.  **Check your district's TIA status** — Use the TEA link above. If approved, find out your district's specific TIA plan and weighting.
2.  **Know your numbers** — Get your most recent T-TESS observation scores and any available student growth data. You need a baseline.
3.  **Start an evidence folder** — Create a digital folder TODAY. Save lesson plans, student work samples, observation feedback, PD certificates, and anything showing your impact.
4.  **Talk to your appraiser** — Ask which observation rubric domains matter most for TIA in your district. Request a pre-observation conference.
5.  **Track student growth** — Identify 2-3 data points you can use to show student progress over time. Pre/post assessments are gold.

 **Want the complete guide?**

Get the **FULL TIA Portfolio Guide & Evidence Collection Kit** at our TPT store!
Includes designation-level rubric breakdowns, evidence templates, observation prep checklists, and more.

 **Teach4Texas on TPT** — Search "Teach4Texas" or visit our store page